

Council Meeting
September 25, 2024
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, September 25, 2024, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:00 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter -absent
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

NON-PUBLIC RSA 91-A:3, II (a)

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also Invited:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

Motion by Assistant Mayor Matteau to enter Non-Public under RSA 91-A:3, II (a) and seconded by Councilor Limoges.

Roll Call Vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion Carried 8-0

Entered nonpublic at 6:02 PM

Description of matters discussed and decisions made *(Note: any votes taken in non-public must be by roll call vote with the vote of each member included in the minutes of the nonpublic session and should be either repeated or disclosed of immediately upon exiting public session.)*

Discussed City Manager’s Performance.

Motion to leave nonpublic session and return to public session by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne

Roll Call Vote:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion Carried 8-0

Reentered public session at 6:46 PM

These minutes were recorded by Assistant Mayor Matteau

AGENDA CHANGES

Manager Manale requests to remove item I for correction of the Recreational Trails Program.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to accept the minutes of the September 11, 2024, City Council meeting.

Roll call / Voice vote:

Koloski – Present

Greenrose – Present

Limoges - Present

Matteau – Present

Hemingway – Present

Zutter – Absent

Hayden – Present

O'Hearne – Present

Girard – Present

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Girard read a proclamation for Laurie Wood who was a long-term employee of the city.

On Saturday, September 28th 7:30-11 Claremont Soup kitchen on Central Street will be hosting a Community Fall Breakfast.

Parks and Recreation will be hosting the Annual Chili Cook Off Saturday, October 5th from 10:00am – 2:00pm.

Friday, October 11th the annual Fireman's parade will take place at 6:30pm.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Manale gave an update on the Sullivan Street sidewalk project, this should be completed this week.

Manager Manale informs public of Water main project. The project will replace main lines to remove any lead in the area.

Tyler street culvert is just about complete with traffic opening in the following weeks.

In house paving will take place on East green mountain road along with crack sealing around town that was completed.

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The Parks and Recreation Department has been rewarded two thousand five hundred dollars from Walmart for fireworks cost.

Scott baker from DPW made a replacement plaque base for Santagate bridge.

County community power committee continues to meet to discuss next steps including the Sullivan County draft electric location plan.

Acuity application DES the application is now complete and can be reviewed. Once this the city is notified, information will get out to the public.

Councilor Hemingway mentioned an accident on Tyler Street. Also mentioned the planter being ripped out on Sullivan Street.

Councilor O'Hearne inquired about the Sullivan Street project design and correction.

Director Merrill explains the design and Sullivan Street project with the tree ripping out the sidewalk. Early on the maps showed that piece.

Councilor O'Hearne inquiring about approving the bond on pleasant street, asks why was this not brought back in front of the council for the left-over funds.

Director Merrill explains the same designer to do the rest of the block to match pleasant street project.

Councilor O'Hearne would like more information on why that spot was chosen.

Director Merrill addresses Councilor O'Hearne that the reason the spot was chosen was based on how many complaints the city received about the condition of that sidewalk area and tree.

O'Hearne inquires who made that determination.

Director Merrill explains it was discussed internally.

Councilor Koloski agrees with councilor O'Hearne the project was not brought back to Council. Look into Maker space and power addition to power the parking garage.

O'Hearne the information for Sullivan Street should have been brought back. Councilor explained he would like answers on Main Street.

City Manager explains the state approved a was overseeing the project at the time. This project was paid by water and not by the tax payers.

Councilor O'Hearne questions what caused the main break for this project to take place.

Manager explains this was a water project with DOT right on site.

Councilor O'Hearne made calls to the state and was told the state did not get the proper paperwork until after the fact.

Manager Manale reiterates this was not tax payers' money.

Manager Manale states the state official was on site the entire time and direction was followed.

Councilor O'Hearne documentation was not available because approval was all after the fact.

Director Gleason, we have all documentation permits. Explains all the requirements were followed.

Manager Manale the State was satisfied and felt the city complied.

Councilor O'Hearne questions if there were before and after pictures taken.

Director Gleason states yes, the city took pictures.

Councilor O'Hearne would have liked to see photos.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Rob Walker Ward I- Mr. Walker is the owner of wheelhouse bike shop and operator of arrowhead. A spring event called impact the trails took place where the Wheelhouse received donations for trails. Trail improvements. Improvements up to seven thousand has been put into the infostructure, not by tax payers. Camping for the bike race, chamber and ARC had a hand in the race. September 22-23 a mountain bike race took place. Media coverage will be showcasing this event. ECC finals will be in Moody Park and in Arrowhead. Bike shop and volunteers are single track trail is being worked on for signage as well. Saturday October 12th TLC held. ECC mountain bike race.

OLD BUSINESS

PILOT Agreement – Grissom Lane Solar Project

Manager Manale explains the pilot. 4 megawatts.

Mr. Hamilton Pilot agreement payments will be coming to the city as revenue. Dedicated revenue stream to the city.

Manager Manale the Planning board approved the site plans.

Councilor Koloski inquires if any construction has been started

Manager Manale explains no the company is waiting for the pilot to go through.

Councilor Hemingway questions the expiration of the agreement.

Assistant Mayor Matteau explains there is a two-month extension if it is needed.

Councilor Hemingway reads items he has researched.

Manager Manale explains the smaller size of 4 megawatts. If the company wanted to expand they have to expand that inner connection.

Mayor Girard questions if we are seeing any places where they are valuing solar farms.

Mr. Hamilton states there is a large system of distribution in Moultonborough not aware of other towns.

Councilor Koloski questions environmental hazard and not paying.

Manager explains the company must pay the city.

Director Merrill explains the interconnection around the city and they all have basked on the age of having a certain capacity. Anything over 1 megawatt. It will not impact other resident consumers.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Assistant mayor Matteau to approve the Pilot agreement.

Roll call / Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway –yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

NEW BUSINESS

Hope2Freedom Recovery Presentation (City Manager/Shawn Cannizzaro)

Mr. Cannizzaro thanks the council. Explains recovery homes. Recovery friendly workplace. Gen foot recovery ready workplace. Explains how he was able to meet recovery needs during this time.

Samantha from recovery program gave a brief presentation.

Councilor Limoges inquires how a workplace would know an individual was ready for the program.

Mr. Cannizzaro explains the way Hope2Freedom Recovery goes about assisting workplaces.

Mrs. Levendeski explains how the program would work with the City and HR for the workplace.

Assistant Mayor Matteau expresses that she supports this program. Certainly, in favor.

2023 Draft Audit Presentation (City Manager/Director of Finance)

Director Bates reviews page fifty-seven. Explains she believes that balance will increase.

Mayor Girard questions why the numbers are different between page two and page fifty-seven.

Director Bates explains according to gap by fund and budgetary. Budgetary basis being a municipality city wide not just general fund.

Mayor Girard going back to last year when the tax rate was set the city had quite a few items tied to the fun balance.

Director Bates states the Auditor does receive all the resolutions. There are five different fun balances with only one unassigned and the other five are committed.

Councilor Koloski explains one of our items is for Washington street paving, expresses he is not comfortable discussing without the auditor present.

Director Bates explained why she brought the audit to the council before the auditor was able to attend in person.

Councilor Kolosk questions if this will be the first year the Council will not be able to weigh in on the audit.

Director Bates, please keep in mind the work was done FY23. Director continues to Explains she is preparing for the 24 audits

Councilor Koloski states he understands it is common practice to switch audit firms.

Director Bates confirms Councilor Koloski's states that it is standard practice to look at different audit firms. The city has been with the same firm for about 10 Years.

Councilor Greenrose states the cost of materials is down.

Manager Manale explains the company said they will honor the contract.

Councilor Koloski Washington street intersection. Explains he appreciates the detailed response.

Director Gleason They will hold the prices if there is a contract signed.

Assistant Mayor Matteau states they will hold a price if we sign a contract.

Councilor Hayden confirms there are only 4 meetings left. Questioning if the council is ok with letting this go if we do not have the audit in the next four meetings.

Councilor Koloski explains why he wants the audit in front of him before making any decision. Would like to have a scope of the project so that the people at home can see it as well.

Councilor Hayden expresses he believes the public can see the agenda online. Councilor Hayden also express he feels our finance Director and City Manager have given one number for the audit and he believes that number is true.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asks Director Bates believes we will have the audit in the months to come before the.

Director Bates the numbers are from the auditor. And she would not give us the numbers if she was not confident.

Director Bates confirms the bond bank is not willing to work with us until the audit is complete.

Resolution 2025-15 Department of Public Works Equipment Vehicles and Equipment Reserve – Public Hearing (City Manager/Director of Finance)

Manager Manale explains the resolution. Current contract the company can finish this project in 2 weeks.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2025-15

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway –yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2025-16 Fire Department Apparatus and Equipment Reserve - Public Hearing

Director Bates explains the resolution, and recommends transfer to capital reserve to clean up the balance sheet.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resolution 2025-16.

Director Bates states the city is sending a check to the trustees for anything they have sold in the next year or two.

Mayor Girard questions if all departments have a capital reserve fund established

Director Bates explains the department is working on all capital reserve funds.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0

Ordinance # 636 - Zoning amendment – Residential 1/Residential 2 Density -First Reading
(City Manager/Director of Planning & Development)

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to send ordinance 636 to a second reading at the October 9th Council Meeting.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Hemingway –yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0

Ordinance # 637 - Zoning amendment - Residential 1/Residential 2 New Duplexes
First Reading (City Manager/Director of Planning & Development)

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to send ordinance 637 to a second reading at the October 9th Council Meeting.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Hemingway –yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0

Ordinance # 638 - Zoning amendment City Center Parking - First Reading (City

Manager/Director of Planning & Development)

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Limoges to send ordinance 637 to a second reading at the October 9th Council Meeting.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway –yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Request to Name City Owned Property – Claremont Dog Park (City Manager/ Parks

Director Martin Explains request.

Councilor Koloski explains why he does not agree with naming a specific place within Moody Park.

Manager Manale explains all bike trails are named specifically.

Councilor O’Hearne this was not brought to the council in the first place.

Mayor Girard expresses he feels this was in poor taste.

Councilor Koloski agreed this was agreed in poor taste. When something was decided on a letter from the board would come to the council.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by no one; no vote was taken.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Assistant Mayor Matteau explains The Planning Board for the expansion of Collision pro on Charlestown Road that was approved.

Councilor Koloski explains the Arts Committee City owned assets tracking and value. Ranking system will be put together. UNH engaged with Director Merrill.

Councilor Hemingway states Planning Code of conduct will be brought to council before it get s sent to council

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Greenrose would like to hear more about Arrowhead.

Manager Manale will speak to Councilor Zutter on bringing

Councilor Limoges reminds the Council of Tolles homes on the agenda.

Manager Manale Contracting out for some maintenance for next year.

Councilor Koloski states a new home page on the website was implemented.

Manager Manale update brochures and the plan is to do exactly what you are saying.

Councilor Koloski would like to have an update on active net.

Manager Manale explains RFP has been sent out and we have received several bids back.

Assistant Mayor Matteau would like to see the packet and have the packet available the Friday it is put out.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:25 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Council O'Hearne to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway –yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Jamie Foster DeRosa
Acting Clerk to the Council